

Classroom SEL pack, a week on gratitude, ages 3 to 7

Rainy Day, Shiny Things

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Shiny things jar	At the end of each day, children name one ‘shiny thing’ that happened. Add a shiny piece to the jar for each one. On a grey day, look at how full the jar has become.	Page 8
Day 5 Thank-you without words	Thank-you without words, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Belonging and Contributing, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours, Problem Solving and Innovating

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a small jar, paper ‘shiny things’ (foil or yellow paper), a rain stick or a cup of rice in a bottle

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: How many cats can you see? What is the weather like? Ask: What do you do on a rainy day? Do rainy days ever make you grumpy? Take a few answers. Listen to the rain: tip a rain stick or a bottle of rice slowly. Ask: Does that sound nice or annoying? Listen again at the end of the story.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Mrs. Maple tucks the cats in every night. How does Mrs.	Maple look after the cats?	tucks them in, scratches their ears, loves them
6	We meet Whiskers, Shadow and Mittens.	How are the three cats different?	curious, quiet, playful
7	‘Why does it have to rain?’	Why is Whiskers grumpy?	he can’t go out and chase the butterfly
9	Mittens is bored with her toy mouse.	Why were the cats grumpy on the rainy day?	no sun, no outside, bored
10	A crash! The pieces sparkle like stars. What happened to the cats’	grumpiness?	they forgot it, they got curious
12	The cats feel Mrs. Maple’s love.	What good things did the cats have, even on a rainy day?	an adventure, food, care, love, each other
13	They purr and rub against her legs.	How did the cats say thank you without words?	purring, rubbing against her
14	Now the rain sounds soothing.	Why does the rain sound different now?	they feel happy, calm, thankful

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Being grumpy is allowed. Gratitude is about noticing good things, not pretending everything is fine. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

grumpy

in a bad mood, cross

Do it: fold your arms and frown

shiny

bright and sparkly in the light

Do it: flick your fingers open like sparkles

notice

to see something you didn't see before

Do it: point to your eyes

thankful

happy about something good you have

Do it: hands on your heart

soothing

calming and gentle

Do it: stroke your arm slowly

Gratitude

The value in this book.

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Every day, rainy or sunny, has something special.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



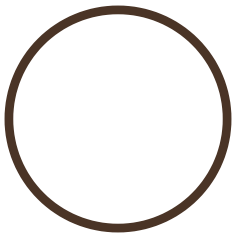
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

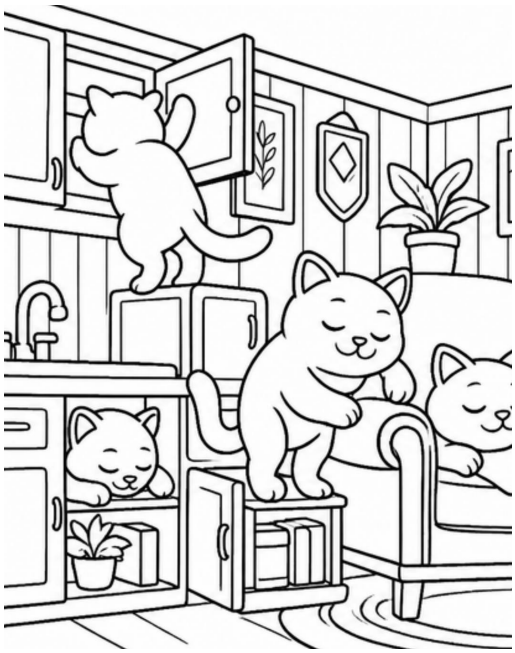
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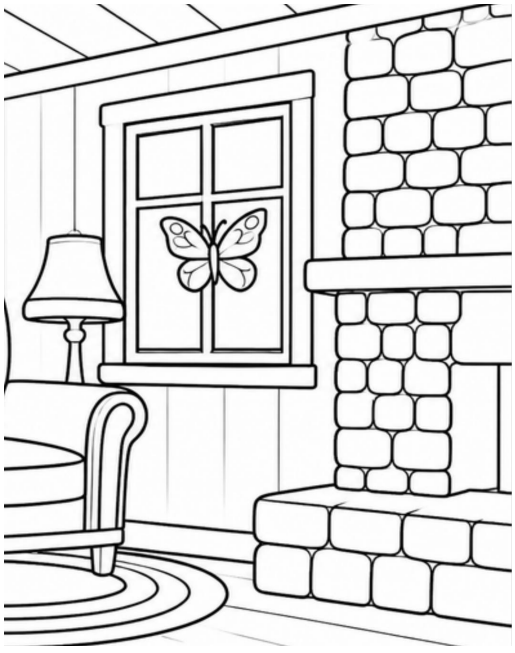
Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Shiny things jar

5 minutes a day, Whole class, Materials: A jar, foil or yellow paper pieces

At the end of each day, children name one ‘shiny thing’ that happened. Add a shiny piece to the jar for each one. On a grey day, look at how full the jar has become.

Thank-you without words

10 minutes, Pairs, Materials: None

Like the cats, find ways to say thank you without words: a smile, a high five, a helping hand, a drawing. Partners take turns guessing what the ‘thank you’ is for.

Rainy day treasure hunt

15 minutes, Small groups, Materials: A list with pictures

Hunt for small good things in the classroom: something soft, something that makes you smile, something someone made for us. Share what each group found.

Science and nature corner

Cats are curious animals that love to explore, climb and play. Many cats like warm, sunny spots for napping. Cats purr when they feel calm and content, and they rub against people they love, leaving their own special scent. Cats are natural hunters, which is why many vets and wildlife groups suggest keeping pet cats indoors to protect wild birds and small animals.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why were the cats grumpy on the rainy day?

Look for: They couldn't go outside, missed the sun and were bored.

2. What changed their mood?

Look for: A surprise in the kitchen, the shiny wings, and noticing Mrs. Maple's care.

3. How did the cats say thank you to Mrs. Maple without words?

Look for: They purred and rubbed against her legs.

4. What is one special thing that happened today?

Look for: Any answer, big or small.

5. Who looks after you? How could you show them thanks?

Look for: Any answer: a hug, a drawing, a thank you.



The big line

"Every day, rainy or sunny, has something special."

The big idea: Even on a grey, boring day there are good things around us. Noticing them and saying thank you helps us feel happier.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show gratitude this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show gratitude by

Name _____



I can show gratitude by

Name _____



I can show gratitude by

Name _____



I can show gratitude by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Belonging and Contributing	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Problem Solving and Innovating	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book happens at home, so for a place to visit we followed the butterfly. We picked Point Pelee, where thousands of monarchs rest on their way to Mexico.



House cat

Most cats have 24 whiskers, 12 on each side of the face.



House cat (orange tabby)

The word 'tabby' comes from striped silk once made in Baghdad.



House cat (tuxedo)

A gene called the white spotting gene makes the white patches.



Monarch butterfly

Milkweed makes monarchs taste bad, so an animal that eats one feels sick and leaves them alone after.

Point Pelee National Park, Ontario

Whiskers: Real cats can't say thank you, but they do show how they feel, with purrs, slow blinks and the way they hold their tails.

Mittens: Lots of orange tabby cats are boys, so a real Mittens would most likely be a boy too. Girls happen, about 1 in 5.

Shadow: Tuxedo isn't a breed, just a coat pattern, so a real Shadow could be any kind of cat.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/rainy-day-shiny-things

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Teach ‘thank you’ in each child’s home language and say them all together. Use pictures of sunny and rainy weather.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 7, 10 and 13). This book has 17 spreads with short text on each, so it reads quickly.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children keep a small ‘shiny things’ notebook for a week, drawing one good thing each day, then share their favourite.

Handle with care

Being grumpy is allowed. Gratitude is about noticing good things, not pretending everything is fine.

Real-life safety: broken glass is dangerous. Children should never touch it; they should step away and tell a grown-up.

Some children have hard home lives. Keep ‘who looks after you’ open: a family member, a teacher, a friend, a neighbour.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. All over the world, families teach children to notice small good things and to say thank you to the people who care for them.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read Rainy Day, Shiny Things, a story about gratitude. Three grumpy cats on a rainy day discover a surprise, and notice how much love and care they have. At home, at bedtime, ask your child for one 'shiny thing' from their day, and share one of yours. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu Jour de pluie, objets brillants, une histoire sur la reconnaissance. Trois chats grognons, un jour de pluie, découvrent une surprise et remarquent tout l'amour et les soins qu'ils reçoivent. À la maison, au coucher, demandez à votre enfant une « chose brillante » de sa journée, et partagez la vôtre. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre la gratitud. Tres gatos gruñones descubren una sorpresa en un día de lluvia y se dan cuenta de todo el amor y cuidado que tienen. En casa, a la hora de dormir, pida a su hijo o hija una «cosa brillante» de su día y comparta una suya. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über Dankbarkeit gelesen. Drei mürrische Katzen entdecken an einem Regentag eine Überraschung und merken, wie viel Liebe und Fürsorge sie haben. Fragen Sie Ihr Kind zu Hause vor dem Schlafengehen nach einem ‚glänzenden Ding' aus seinem Tag, und erzählen Sie eins von Ihrem. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sulla gratitudine. Tre gatti brontoloni, in un giorno di pioggia, scoprono una sorpresa e si accorgono di quanto amore e cura ricevono. A casa, prima di dormire, chiedete a vostro figlio o vostra figlia una «cosa luccicante» della sua giornata, e raccontate la vostra. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Gratitude: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Gratitude: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Gratitude: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Gratitude: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Rainy Day, Shiny Things

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: gratitude.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Even on a grey, boring day there are good things around us. Noticing them and saying thank you helps us feel happier.

The big line

“Every day, rainy or sunny, has something special.”

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
grumpy	in a bad mood, cross	fold your arms and frown
shiny	bright and sparkly in the light	flick your fingers open like sparkles
notice	to see something you didn’t see before	point to your eyes
thankful	happy about something good you have	hands on your heart
soothing	calming and gentle	stroke your arm slowly

A gentle note

Being grumpy is allowed. Gratitude is about noticing good things, not pretending everything is fine.

Real-life safety: broken glass is dangerous. Children should never touch it; they should step away and tell a grown-up.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Whiskers

House cat

A cat who learns to be thankful on a rainy day



Mittens

House cat (orange tabby)

Whiskers' playful housemate



Shadow

House cat (tuxedo)

The quiet black-and-white housemate



The butterfly

Monarch butterfly

Flutters by the window

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How did they feel?

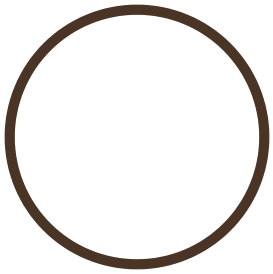
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Mrs. Maple tucks the cats in every night. How does Mrs.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

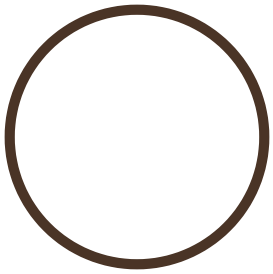


Moment 2

A crash! The pieces sparkle like stars. What happened to the cats'

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

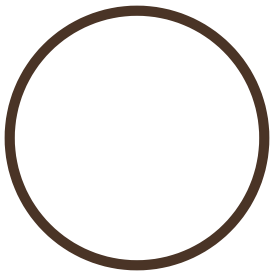


Moment 3

Now the rain sounds soothing.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

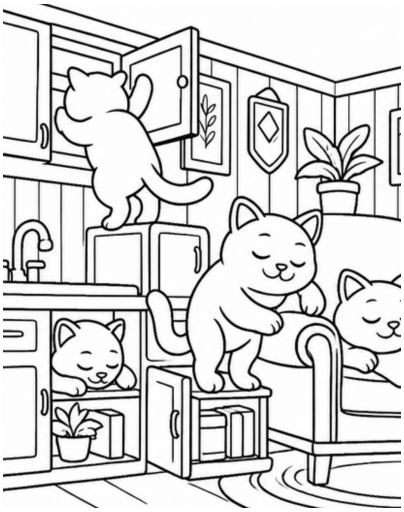
Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

grumpy in a bad mood, cross

grumpy grumpy

shiny bright and sparkly in the light

shiny shiny

notice to see something you didn't see before

notice notice

Whiskers the hero of the story

Whiskers Whiskers

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Whiskers showed gratitude. Draw a time when you showed gratitude too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Thank-you without words

You need: None

Like the cats, find ways to say thank you without words: a smile, a high five, a helping hand, a drawing. Partners take turns guessing what the ‘thank you’ is for.

Thankful window

On a rainy day, look out the window and name three things you're thankful for.

Shiny hunt

Find three shiny things around the house. Which one is your favourite?

Whisker test

Gently blow on the back of your hand. Cats can feel tiny puffs of air like that with their whiskers.

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Rainy Day, Shiny Things are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Whiskers

House cat

Most cats have 24 whiskers, 12 on each side of the face.



Mittens

House cat (orange tabby)

The word 'tabby' comes from striped silk once made in Baghdad.



Shadow

House cat (tuxedo)

A gene called the white spotting gene makes the white patches.



The butterfly

Monarch butterfly

Milkweed makes monarchs taste bad, so an animal that eats one feels sick and leaves them alone after.

Story or real?

Real cats can't say thank you, but they do show how they feel, with purrs, slow blinks and the way they hold their tails.

Where they really live

The book happens at home, so for a place to visit we followed the butterfly. We picked Point Pelee, where thousands of monarchs rest on their way to Mexico.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/rainy-day-shiny-things

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

How many cats can you see? What is the weather like?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 1

Why were the cats grumpy on the rainy day?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 2

What changed their mood?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 3

How did the cats say thank you to Mrs. Maple without words?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 4

What is one special thing that happened today?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 5

Who looks after you? How could you show them thanks?

Rainy Day, Shiny Things, talk card 6

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Gratitude hero

This is to say that

_____

showed gratitude, just like Whiskers.

_____ _____

Signed Date

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